

“The **OPPORTUNITY** Is Tremendous For **ENGINEERS** And **ENTREPRENEURS** Getting Into The Field Of **CHIP DESIGN**”

Electronics and semiconductors are occupying headlines across the globe. What are the learnings for our industry? What are the key opportunities opening for India? To find out answers to such questions we spoke to industry veteran Venkata Sudhakar Simhadri, MD & CEO of MosChip. Here are some extracts of our discussion



Venkata Sudhakar Simhadri
MD & CEO, MosChip

How would you define your journey with respect to the evolution of semiconductor industry?

I have been in the industry for the last 30+ years, starting my career in Silicon Valley. The semiconductor industry had its own ups and downs. There were times when semiconductor companies were laying off people. We had some degrowth or stagnant times in between but, overall, the industry continued to grow.

During my early days in Silicon Valley the growth was fueled by the PC industry followed by networking and communications. Fabless start-ups like Broadcom and Qualcomm did very well and grew rapidly.

The next wave came through

mobile phones and cellular industry. As the mobile industry started getting mature, the emerging fields like IoT, 5G, electric vehicles ADAS, and artificial intelligence started creating more opportunities for start-ups as well as established players. The VC funding into semiconductor start-ups has been picking up in the last 5-6 years.

When I started my career in 1990, the transistor sizes were 1.0 micron and today the same transistor size is 3nm. So, the industry has never been in steady state, it is constantly evolving, and the journey continues to be exciting. India never played a leading role in semiconductor industry, but things are changing. The IC designers in India are as good as the talent in any

other part of the world.

However, we still do not have any large semiconductor product companies out of India, except for a few start-ups trying to break-in. But I strongly believe that it's going to change. The opportunity is tremendous for the engineers and entrepreneurs who are getting into this field. They just need to pick the right opportunities and stay focused.

While most of the chip design work that happens in India is targeted for global markets, are there any low hanging fruits that are developing into a major market in India?

There are many opportunities for addressing local markets. Products like set-top boxes, smart meters, LED lights